

DIGESTIVE SYSTEM

The digestive tract is a tube with selective membranes that control what gets into your body. Nutrients are absorbed and waste is expelled.

SYSTEM OVERVIEW

Food is broken down into absorbable units by your digestive system, from chewing in the mouth to chemical breakdown in the stomach and squeezing in the intestines. Nutrients enter the blood, and ultimately your cells. Yogis recognized that you become what you eat, equating the physical body (*anamaya*) with the “food body.”

Journey of food

It is best to practice yoga asanas on an empty stomach. That may mean not eating a meal 2–4 hours before class. You may need to strategically plan a small snack, especially if you tend to have low blood sugar or other medical conditions.

